

# Connect Hub

## PROJECT OVERVIEW

The **ConnectHub** is a backend web application designed to solve the common problem of scattered contact information across multiple platforms. It provides users with a centralized, organized system to store, search, and categorize their professional and personal contacts.

### Key Objectives:

- Provide secure user authentication and data isolation
- Enable efficient contact management through CRUD operations
- Implement flexible categorization using tags
- Offer fast search and filtering capabilities
- Deliver a responsive, cross-device user experience

### Target Users:

- Freelancers and consultants managing client relationships
- Small business owners tracking vendor and customer contacts
- Students and young professionals building their network
- Event organizers managing attendee and volunteer information
- Anyone seeking a simple, privacy-focused contact management solution

## PROJECT INSTRUCTION

### ❑ Install Node.js (If Not Installed)

Download and install Node.js from: <https://nodejs.org/>

After installation, verify:

**node -v**

**npm -v**

### ❑ Create a Backend Project Folder

- Choose or create a directory where you want your backend.

- Open your terminal or command prompt.
- Navigate to the selected directory:

**cd your-project-folder**

- Create a new backend folder:

**mkdir server**

**cd server**

❏ Initialize Node Project

Run: **npm init -y**

This will create a package.json file.

❏ Install Required Dependencies

Install Express:

**npm install express**

**npm install mongoose**

For development (auto-restart server):

**npm install nodemon --save-dev**

❏ Create Basic Server File

Inside the server folder:

- Create a file called: [server.js](#)

Add this code :

```
import express from "express";

const app = express();
const PORT = 5000;

// Middleware
app.use(express.json());

// Test Route
app.get("/", (req, res) => {
  res.send("Backend is running 🚀");
});

// Start Server
app.listen(PORT, () => {
  console.log(`Server running on http://localhost:${PORT}`);
});
```

## 📦 Enable ES Modules (Important)

Open package.json and add: "type": "module"

**Example:**

```
{
  "name": "server",
  "version": "1.0.0",
  "type": "module",
  "scripts": {
    "dev": "nodemon server.js"
  }
}
```

## 🚀 Start the Backend Server

Run: **npm run dev**

OR if not using nodemon: **node server.js**

## 🌐 Open in Browser

Open: **http://localhost:5000**

You should see: **Backend is running**

## PRE-REQUISITES

### Software Requirements

| Software    | Purpose                         |
|-------------|---------------------------------|
| Node.js     | JavaScript runtime for backend  |
| MongoDB     | NoSQL database for data storage |
| npm         | Package manager                 |
| Git         | Version control system          |
| Code Editor | VS Code, WebStorm, or similar   |

### Knowledge Requirements

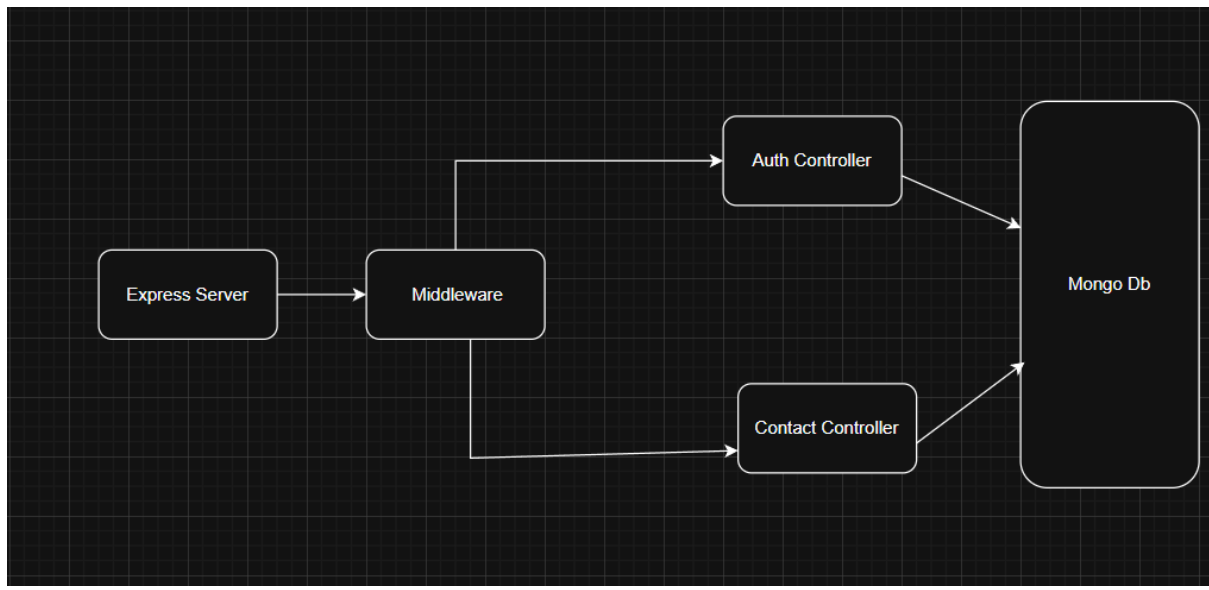
- JavaScript ES6+ syntax and concepts
- Node.js and Express.js for RESTful API development
- MongoDB and Mongoose ODM
- JWT authentication and bcrypt password hashing
- Git version control workflow

### PROJECT THUMBNAIL



### PROJECT ARCHITECTURE

High-level architecture diagram illustrating the three-tier backend structure.



## Node.js + Express Backend

- RESTful API architecture
- JWT authentication middleware
- MVC pattern (Models, Controllers, Routes)
- Input validation and error handling

## MongoDB Database

- Document-based NoSQL storage
- Mongoose ODM for schema modeling
- Two collections: Users and Contacts
- Indexed fields for optimized queries

## TECHNICAL ARCHITECTURE

### Backend Architecture (Node.js + Express)

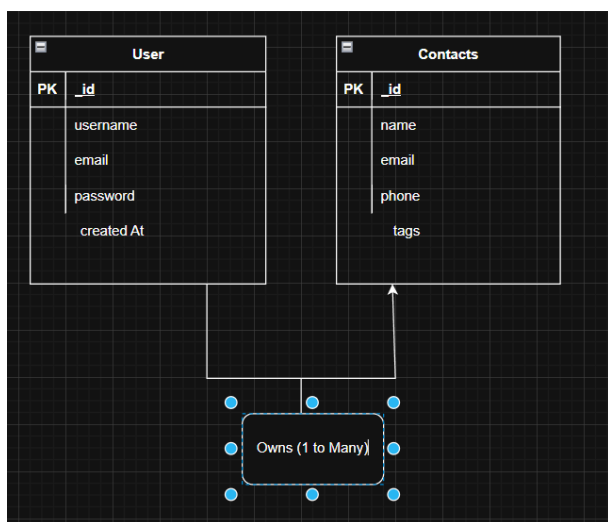
- **Controllers:** Business logic for authentication and CRUD operations
- **Models:** Mongoose schemas defining data structure
- **Routes:** API endpoint definitions with HTTP methods
- **Middleware:** JWT verification, error handling, validation

- **Configuration:** Database connection and environment variables

## Database Architecture (MongoDB)

- **Users Collection:** `_id`, name, email, password (hashed), timestamps
- **Contacts Collection:** `_id`, `userId` (FK), name, email, phone, notes, tags[], timestamps
- **Relationships:** Many-to-One (Contacts → User)
- **Indexes:** email (unique), `userId`, name, tags (for search)

## ER Diagram



## Features

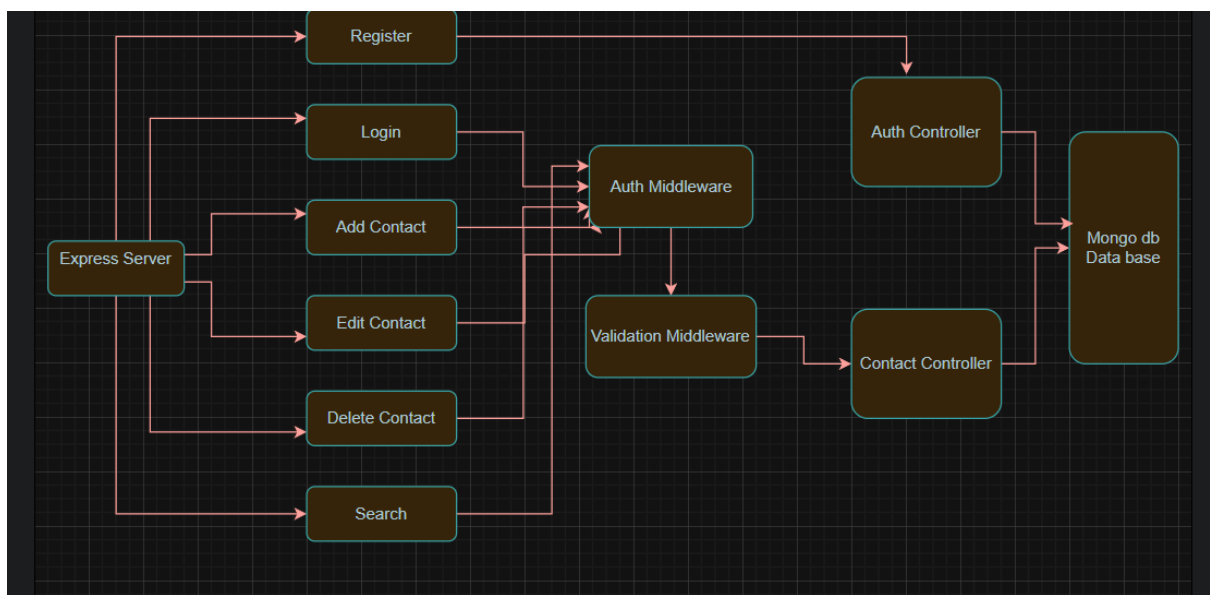
### Core Features

| # | Feature             | Description                                                                               |
|---|---------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | User Authentication | JWT-based registration, login, and session management with bcrypt password hashing        |
| 2 | Contact CRUD        | Create, read, update, and delete contacts with full validation and error handling         |
| 3 | Tag Categorization  | Organize contacts with multiple tags (Work, Family, Friends, etc.) and filter by category |
| 4 | Real-time Search    | Debounced search across name, email, and tags with instant results                        |

### Roles and Responsibility

- User -
  1. Registration - Register on the application using the name, email , password
  2. Login - Login on the application using the email and registered password
  3. Search - Search for a contact using name , email or tags
  4. Add Contact - Add new contact - name , email , phone , notes , tags
  5. Edit Contact - Edit the existing contact
  6. Delete Contact - Delete any contact

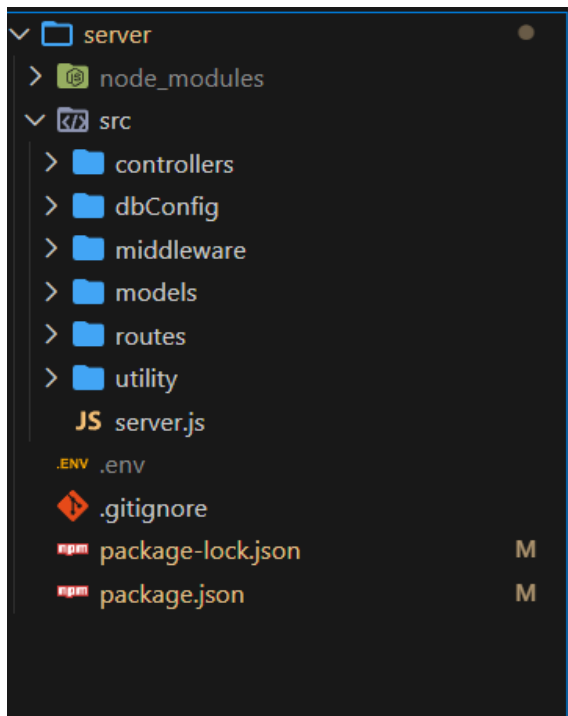
## User Flow



## Project Setup and Configuration

### Folder Structure





## Project Setup

1. Install required tools and software:

- Node.js.
- MongoDB.

2. Create project folders and files:

- Server folders.

3. Install Packages:

Backend npm Packages

- Express.
- Mongoose.
- Cors.

## Backend Development

- Setup express server

- Create index.js file in the server (backend folder).
- Create a .env file and define port number to access it globally.
- Configure the server by adding cors, body-parser.

```
// Middleware
app.use(cors());
app.use(express.json());
app.use(express.urlencoded({ extended: false }));
```

- User Authentication:
- Create routes and middleware for user registration, login, and
- Set up authentication middleware to protect routes that require user authentication.

```
import express from 'express';
const router = express.Router();
import { registerUser, loginUser, getMe } from '../controllers/authController.js';
import authentication from '../middleware/authMiddleware.js';
import { registerValidation, loginValidation } from '../utility/validators.js';
import validate from '../middleware/validation.js';

router.post('/register', registerValidation, validate, registerUser);
router.post('/login', loginValidation, validate, loginUser);
router.get('/me', authentication, getMe);

export default router;
```

- Define API Routes:
- Create separate route files for different API functionalities such as user authentication and crud operation for contacts
- Implement route handlers using Express.js to handle requests and interact with the database.

```
router.get('/search', authentication, searchContacts);
router.route('/')
  .get(authentication, getContacts)
  .post(authentication, contactValidation, validate, createContact);
router.route('/:id')
  .get(authentication, getContactById)
  .put(authentication, updateContactValidation, validate, updateContact)
  .delete(authentication, deleteContact);
```

- Implement Data Models:
- Define Mongoose schemas for the different data entities like user and contact
- Create corresponding Mongoose models to interact with the MongoDB database.

- Implement CRUD operations (Create, Read, Update, Delete) for each model to perform

```
import mongoose from "mongoose";
import bcrypt from 'bcryptjs'
const userSchema = new mongoose.Schema(
  {
    name: {
      type: String,
      required: [true, 'Please add a name'],
      trim: true,
    },
    email: {
      type: String,
      required: [true, 'Please add an email'],
      unique: true,
      lowercase: true,
      trim: true,
      match: [
        /^\.w+([\.-]?\w+)*@\w+([\.-]?\w+)*(\.\w{2,3})+$/,
        'Please add a valid email',
      ],
    },
    password: {
      type: String,
      required: [true, 'Please add a password'],
      minlength: 6,
      select: false,
    },
  },
  {
    timestamps: true,
  }
);
```

database operations.

```
// Hash password before saving
```

```
const contactSchema = new mongoose.Schema(
  {
    userId: {
      type: mongoose.Schema.Types.ObjectId,
      required: true,
      ref: 'User',
    },
    name: {
      type: String,
      required: [true, 'Please add a contact name'],
      trim: true,
    },
    email: {
      type: String,
      trim: true,
      lowercase: true,
      match: [
        /^\.w+([\.-]?\w+)*@\w+([\.-]?\w+)*(\.\w{2,3})+$/ ,
        'Please add a valid email',
      ],
    },
    phone: {
      type: String,
      trim: true,
    },
    tags: {
      type: [String],
      default: [],
    },
  },
  {
    timestamps: true,
  }
);
```

- Error Handling:
- Implement error handling middleware to catch and handle any errors that occur during the API requests.
- Return appropriate error responses with relevant error messages and HTTP status codes.

```
const errorHandler = (err, req, res, next) => {
  const statusCode = res.statusCode === 200 ? 500 : res.statusCode;

  res.status(statusCode).json({
    message: err.message,
    stack: process.env.NODE_ENV === 'production' ? null : err.stack,
  });
};

const notFound = (req, res, next) => {
  const error = new Error(`Not Found - ${req.originalUrl}`);
  res.status(404);
  next(error);
};

export { errorHandler, notFound };
```

## Database Configuration and Setup

### 1. Configure MongoDB:

- Install Mongoose.
- Create database connection.
- Create Schemas & Models.

## 2. Connect database to backend:

Now, make sure the database is connected before performing any of the actions through the backend. The connection code looks similar to the one provided below.

```
const PORT = process.env.PORT || 6001;
mongoose.connect(process.env.MONGO_URL, {
  useNewUrlParser: true,
  useUnifiedTopology: true
}).then(()=>{

  server.listen(PORT, ()=>{
    console.log(`Running @ ${PORT}`);
  });

}).catch((err)=>{
  console.log("Error: ", err);
})
```

## 3. Configure Schema:

Firstly, configure the Schemas for MongoDB database, to store the data in such pattern. Use the data from the ER diagrams to create the schemas.

The schemas are looks like for the Application.

```
server > models > JS User.js > ...
1  import mongoose from 'mongoose';
2
3  const UserSchema = new mongoose.Schema({
4    username: {
5      type: String,
6      require: true
7    },
8    email: {
9      type: String,
10     require: true,
11     unique: true
12   },
13   password: {
14     type: String,
15     require: true
16   },
17 });
18
19 const User = mongoose.model("users", UserSchema);
20 export default User;
```

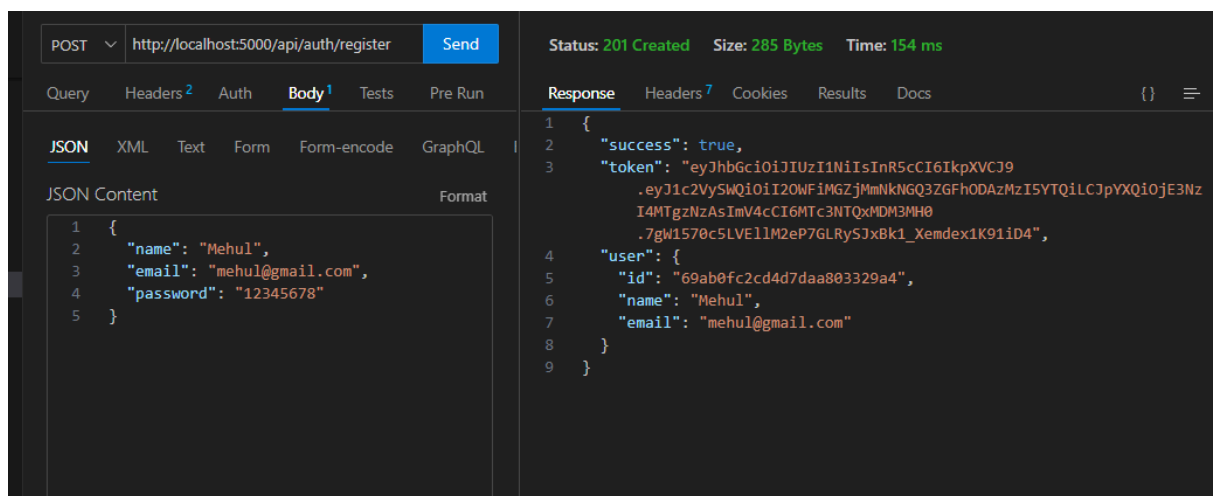
## Project Execution

### Execution Steps

1. Open the project folder in the terminal
2. Make sure you have a start script in the [package.js](#) file
3. Use the command **npm start** to start the server
4. You will the **Running on PORT** message on the successfully starting the server
5. You will also see the database connected message if the database is connected successfully
6. Use the Thunder client or Postman for using the created api's

### Output Screenshot

1. Register Api



## 2. Login Api

The screenshot shows a REST client interface with a POST request to `http://localhost:5000/api/auth/login`. The request body is a JSON object containing email and password. The response is a 200 OK status with a JSON body containing success, token, and user information.

```
POST http://localhost:5000/api/auth/login
```

JSON Content

```
1 {
2   "email": "mehul@gmail.com",
3   "password": "12345678"
4 }
```

Status: 200 OK Size: 285 Bytes Time: 178 ms

Response

```
1 {
2   "success": true,
3   "token": "eyJhbGciOiJIUzI1NiIsInR5cCI6IkpXVCJ9.eyJ1c2VySwQiOiI2OWFiMGZjMmNkNGQ3ZGFhODAzMzI5YTQilCJpYXQiOjE3NzI4MTg4OTQsImV4cCI6MTc3NTQxMDg5NH0.20ZVpMQ_k3nnwpkneF8wbX5s16y4pyT0vLXwDyYS3_A",
4   "user": {
5     "id": "69ab0fc2cd4d7daa803329a4",
6     "name": "Mehul",
7     "email": "mehul@gmail.com"
8   }
9 }
```

## 3. Create New Contact

The screenshot shows a REST client interface with a POST request to `http://localhost:5000/api/contacts/`. The request body is a JSON object containing name and email. The response is a 201 Created status with a JSON body containing success, contact details, and timestamps.

```
POST http://localhost:5000/api/contacts/
```

JSON Content

```
1 {
2   "name": "saiabhyankkar",
3   "email": "abhyyyy@gmail.com"
4 }
```

Status: 201 Created Size: 244 Bytes Time: 31 ms

Response

```
1 {
2   "success": true,
3   "contact": {
4     "userId": "69ab0fc2cd4d7daa803329a4",
5     "name": "saiabhyankkar",
6     "email": "abhyyyy@gmail.com",
7     "tags": [],
8     "_id": "69ab1519a7f3b083d4ac603d",
9     "createdAt": "2026-03-06T17:55:37.516Z",
10    "updatedAt": "2026-03-06T17:55:37.516Z",
11    "__v": 0
12  }
13 }
```

## 4. Update Contact

PUT ⌵ http://localhost:5000/api/contacts/69ab1519a7f3b083d4ac603d Send

Query Headers <sup>2</sup> Auth <sup>1</sup> **Body <sup>1</sup>** Tests Pre Run

**JSON** XML Text Form Form-encode GraphQL Binary

JSON Content Format

```
1 {
2   "phone": "9876512340",
3   "tags": ["test"]
4 }
5
```

Status: 200 OK Size: 271 Bytes Time: 31 ms

Response Headers <sup>7</sup> Cookies Results Docs {} ≡

```
1 {
2   "success": true,
3   "contact": {
4     "_id": "69ab1519a7f3b083d4ac603d",
5     "userId": "69ab0fc2cd4d7daa803329a4",
6     "name": "saiabhyankkar",
7     "email": "abhyyyy@gmail.com",
8     "tags": [
9       "test"
10    ],
11    "createdAt": "2026-03-06T17:55:37.516Z",
12    "updatedAt": "2026-03-06T17:59:18.269Z",
13    "__v": 1,
14    "phone": "9876512340"
15  }
16 }
```

## 5. Delete Contact

DELETE ⌵ http://localhost:5000/api/contacts/69ab1519a7f3b083d4ac603d Send

Query Headers <sup>2</sup> Auth <sup>1</sup> **Body <sup>1</sup>** Tests Pre Run

**JSON** XML Text Form Form-encode GraphQL Binary

JSON Content Format

```
1 {
2   "phone": "9876512340",
3   "tags": ["test"]
4 }
5
```

Status: 200 OK Size: 57 Bytes Time: 19 ms

Response Headers <sup>7</sup> Cookies Results Docs {} ≡

```
1 {
2   "success": true,
3   "message": "Contact deleted successfully"
4 }
```

## 6. Search Contact



GET http://localhost:5000/api/contacts/search?q=test 

Send

Query

Headers 2

Auth 1

Body

Tests

Pre Run

Query Parameters

☒

qtest

☐parametervalue

Status: 200 OKSize: 40 BytesTime: 31 ms

Response

Headers 7

Cookies

Results

Docs

{}

1

{

2

"success": true,

3

"count": 0,

4

"contacts": []

5

}

## 7. Get The Current User

GET http://localhost:5000/api/auth/me 

Send

Query

Headers 2

Auth 1

Body 1

Tests

Pre Run

None

Basic

Bearer

OAuth 2

NTLM

AWS

Bearer Token

eyJhbGciOiJIUzI1NiIsInR5cCI6IkpXVCJ9.eyJ1c2VySWQiOiI2OWFiMGZjMmNkNGQ3ZGFhODAzMzI5YTQiLCJpYXQiOiJlY3NzI4MTk2ODUsImV4cCI6MTc3NTQxMTY4NX06HkZE\_EOMlwB40TBGaSgieOfKaK-Ko8nb9kfgC3hG\_M

Token Prefix

Bearer

Status: 200 OKSize: 98 BytesTime: 6 ms

Response

Headers 7

Cookies

Results

Docs

{}

1

{

2

"success": true,

3

"user": {

4

"id": "69ab0fc2cd4d7daa803329a4",

5

"name": "Mehul",

6

"email": "mehul@gmail.com"

7

}

8

}

Project Demo:

[https://drive.google.com/file/d/1Nee4aWXZIy13guyyVCzOBcFcmsDTfn9p/view?usp=drive\\_sdk](https://drive.google.com/file/d/1Nee4aWXZIy13guyyVCzOBcFcmsDTfn9p/view?usp=drive_sdk)

Code Link:

<https://github.com./manimozhi432-prg/contact-manager-git>